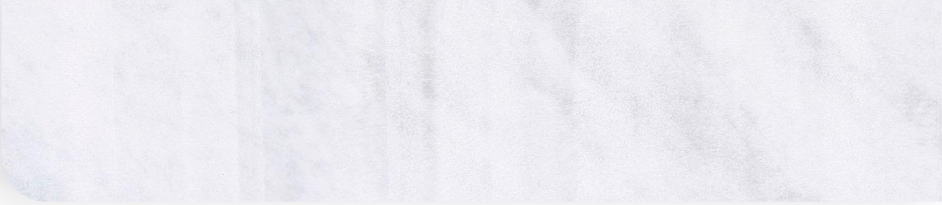


Module 5

Collegiality and loyalty – Managing conflict- Respect for authority- Collective bargaining

Confidentiality-Role of confidentiality in moral integrity-Conflicts of interest- Occupational crime- Professional rights-Employee right- IPR Discrimination
Global ethical issues- Business ethics, Computer Ethics, Environment ethics –
Role in technological development-Engineers as Managers- Consulting Engineers- Engineers as Expert witnesses and advisors.





Collegiality

- **Collegiality** means having a spirit of **cooperation, respect, and mutual support** among colleagues in a professional setting.
- It emphasizes **working together harmoniously**, sharing knowledge, and helping each other achieve both individual and organizational goals.
- Collegiality = **Team spirit, cooperation, and mutual respect**.
- Essential for professional growth, ethical responsibility, and organizational success.
- Without collegiality, workplaces face **conflict, mistrust, and inefficiency**.



Features of Collegiality

Respect → Valuing others' opinions, skills, and contributions.

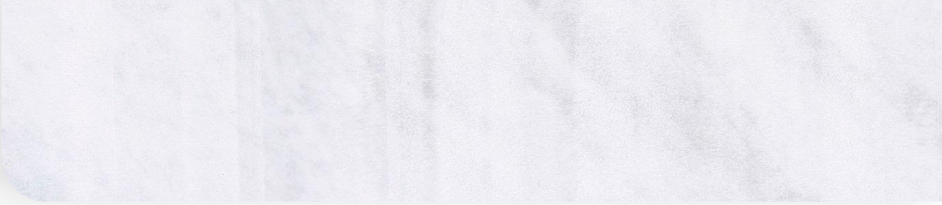
Cooperation → Willingness to collaborate and support team goals.

Shared Responsibility → Accepting collective accountability for outcomes.

Open Communication → Honest and constructive feedback.

Trust and Integrity → Building confidence in each other's professionalism.

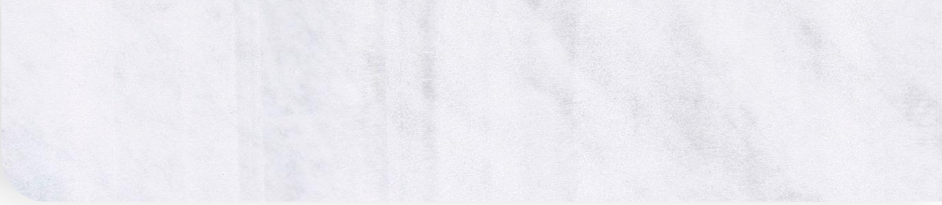




Importance of Collegiality in Professional Ethics

- Promotes **healthy workplace culture**.
- Reduces **conflicts and misunderstandings**.
- Enhances **team productivity and creativity**.
- Encourages **learning and knowledge-sharing**.
- Builds a **trustworthy professional reputation**.

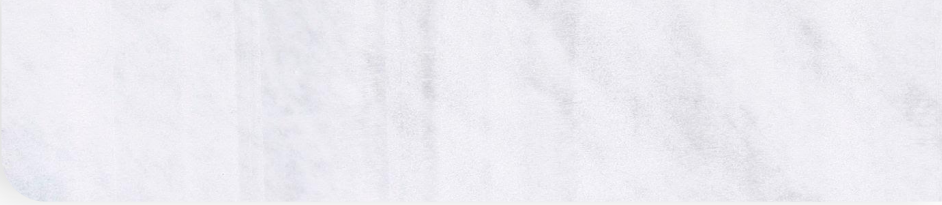




Examples of Collegiality

- **In Engineering:** Senior engineers mentoring juniors on complex designs.
- **In Teaching:** Teachers sharing teaching materials and supporting each other during workloads.
- **In Healthcare:** Doctors, nurses, and technicians working as a team for patient care.
- **In Business:** Colleagues backing each other in presentations or covering tasks during emergencies.





Case Example

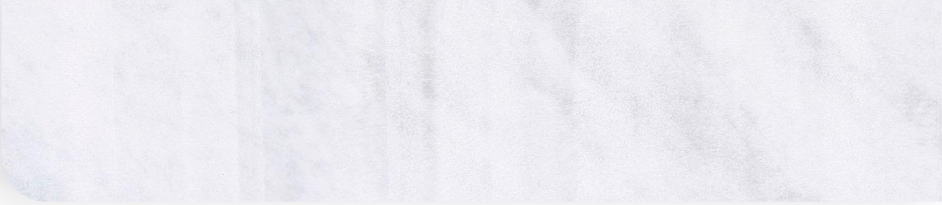
- **Positive Example:** In software development, team members openly share code improvements and help debug issues → project delivered faster.
- **Negative Example:** Lack of collegiality (competition, blame game) can delay projects and harm organizational trust.



Loyalty

- **Loyalty** means **faithfulness, trustworthiness, and commitment** to a person, group, profession, or organization.
- In professional ethics, loyalty is about **supporting one's organization, colleagues, and clients**, while **balancing it with ethical responsibilities** to society.
- Loyalty = **Faithfulness and commitment** to people, profession, and ethics.
- True loyalty is **not blind** → it respects **honesty, integrity, and public safety**.
- Professionals must balance **loyalty to employer** with **loyalty to ethical values and society**.





Types of Loyalty

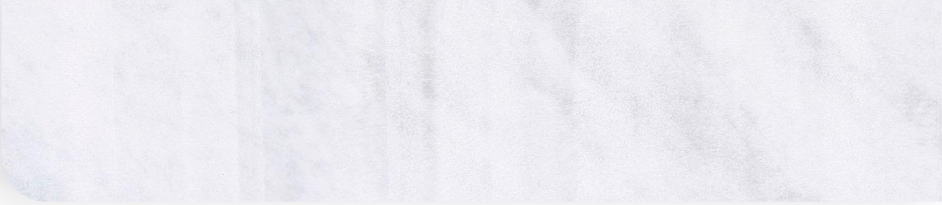
1. **Personal Loyalty** → Being faithful to friends, family, or mentors.
2. **Professional Loyalty** → Commitment to one's organization, employer, or profession.
3. **Public Loyalty** → Responsibility towards society, community, or nation.
4. **Ethical Loyalty** → Staying loyal to moral values like truth, justice, and fairness.



Importance of Loyalty in Professional Ethics

- Builds **trust and reliability** between employer and employee.
- Creates a **sense of belonging and teamwork**.
- Encourages **long-term relationships** with clients and stakeholders.
- Promotes **organizational growth** by reducing conflicts.
- Prevents **unethical practices** like betrayal, corruption, or leaking information.





Examples of Loyalty

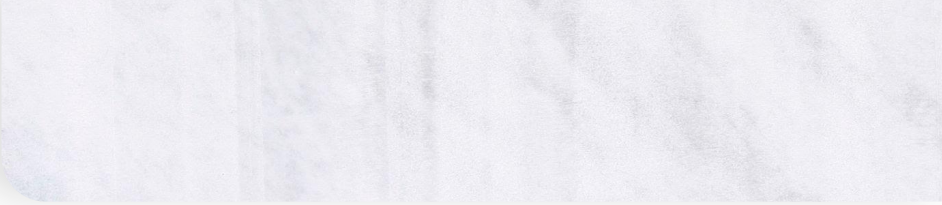
- **Engineering:** An engineer reports safety flaws in a project to protect public safety, showing loyalty to ethical standards rather than just to the company.
- **Business:** Employees not sharing confidential company strategies with competitors.
- **Healthcare:** A doctor remaining loyal to patients by prioritizing their well-being over profits.
- **Personal:** Standing by a friend in difficult times while still being honest.



Challenges in Loyalty (Moral Dilemma)

- **Conflict of Loyalty** → Choosing between loyalty to employer and loyalty to public welfare.
 - Example: If a company hides harmful product effects, should the engineer stay loyal to the company or expose the truth for society's safety?
- **Blind Loyalty** → Supporting someone or an organization unethically (e.g., covering up mistakes). This **violates professional ethics**.

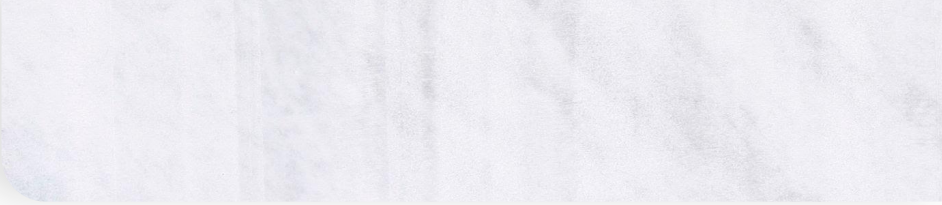




Managing conflict

- **Conflict** occurs when there is a **clash of interests, opinions, or goals** between individuals or groups.
- **Managing conflict** means resolving disagreements in a **constructive, respectful, and ethical way** without harming relationships.
- Effective management of conflict is essential for maintaining **teamwork, productivity, and ethical behavior**.





Types of Conflict

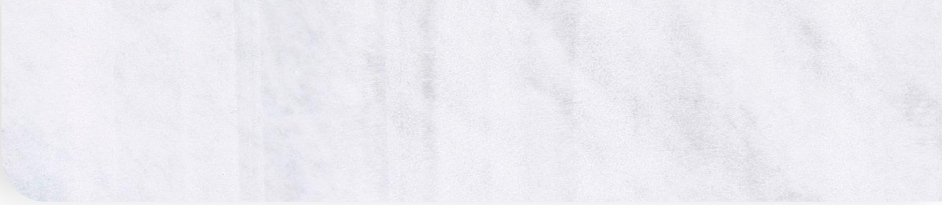
1. **Intrapersonal Conflict** – within an individual (e.g., ethical dilemma at work).
2. **Interpersonal Conflict** – between two individuals (e.g., colleague disagreements).
3. **Intragroup Conflict** – within a team (e.g., role ambiguity).
4. **Intergroup/Organizational Conflict** – between departments, organizations, or companies.



Causes of Conflict in Workplace

- Miscommunication or lack of clarity.
- Competition for limited resources.
- Differences in values, ethics, or priorities.
- Unclear roles and responsibilities.
- Personality clashes and ego issues.

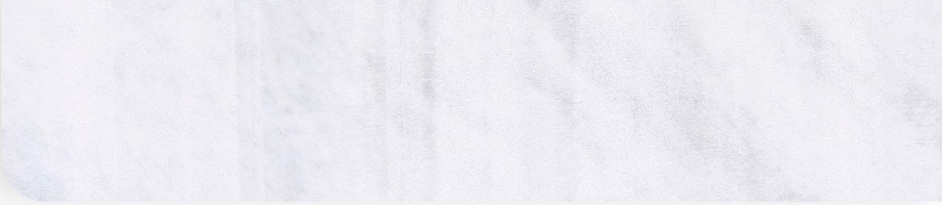




Conflict Management Styles (Thomas-Kilmann Model)

1. **Avoiding** – Ignoring the conflict, hoping it resolves itself.
2. **Competing** – Forcing one's viewpoint at the expense of others.
3. **Accommodating** – Giving in to others to maintain harmony.
4. **Compromising** – Each side gives up something to reach a middle ground.
5. **Collaborating** – Working together to find a win-win solution (most ethical & effective).

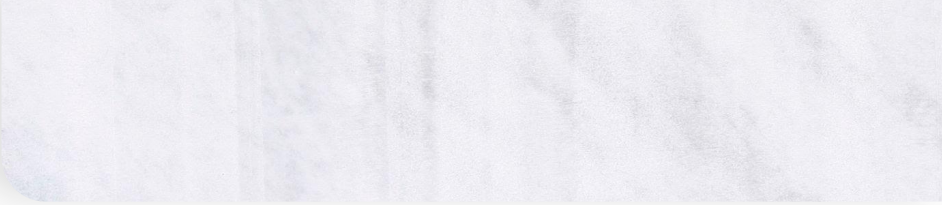




Steps in Managing Conflict (Ethical Approach)

1. **Identify the source** – Understand the root cause.
2. **Communicate openly** – Allow all parties to express views.
3. **Focus on issues, not personalities** – Keep discussions professional.
4. **Generate options** – Explore multiple possible solutions.
5. **Select the best ethical solution** – Choose a resolution that aligns with fairness and organizational values.
6. **Implement and monitor** – Ensure the solution is accepted and effective.

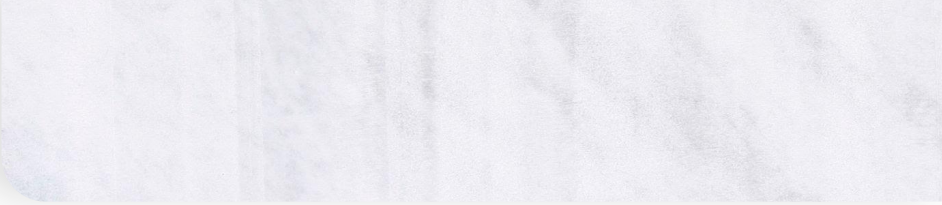




Examples of Conflict in Professional Life

- **Engineering Ethics:** A project team argues whether to prioritize **safety vs. cost reduction**.
- **Business Ethics:** Sales and production teams disagree about delivery deadlines.

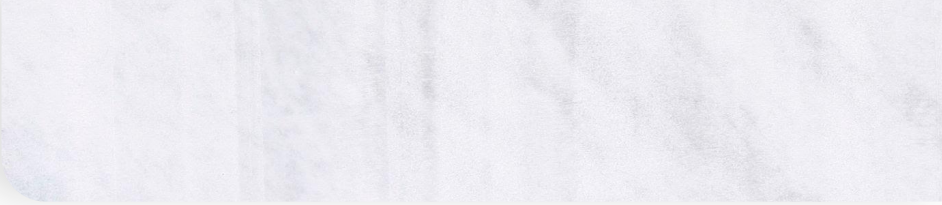




Benefits of Effective Conflict Management

- Encourages creativity and innovation (diverse ideas).
- Improves problem-solving skills.
- Strengthens relationships and trust.
- Enhances productivity and teamwork.
- Ensures ethical decision-making.





Key Ethical Principles in Conflict Resolution

- **Respect** – Listen to all parties fairly.
- **Integrity** – Be honest in expressing views.
- **Justice** – Ensure fair treatment.
- **Responsibility** – Own mistakes and work toward solutions.



Respect for authority

- It means recognizing, accepting, and valuing the **legitimate roles, responsibilities, and decisions** of people in positions of authority (teachers, managers, leaders, law enforcement, government, professional bodies, etc.).
- It does not mean blind obedience, but rather **following rules, guidelines, and ethical instructions** in a professional and social context.

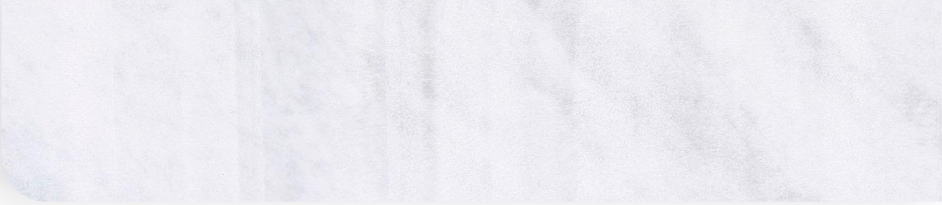
Example : In an engineering firm, an employee respects the manager's decision to prioritize **safety over profit**, even though it may delay project completion. This shows respect for authority aligned with **ethical responsibility**.



Importance in Professional Ethics

- Ensures **discipline and order** in organizations.
- Promotes **smooth functioning of teams** under leadership.
- Builds **trust and accountability** between employees and leaders.
- Helps maintain **professional standards and legal compliance**.





Examples of Respect for Authority

1. **Workplace** – Following instructions of a project manager, even if you have a different opinion, while still respectfully suggesting improvements.
2. **Academics** – Respecting teachers by listening attentively, submitting assignments on time, and following classroom rules.
3. **Engineering Profession** – Abiding by professional codes of conduct issued by institutions (like IEEE, AICTE, or government regulations).
4. **Society** – Obeying laws such as traffic rules, taxation, and safety regulations.



Ethical Dimension

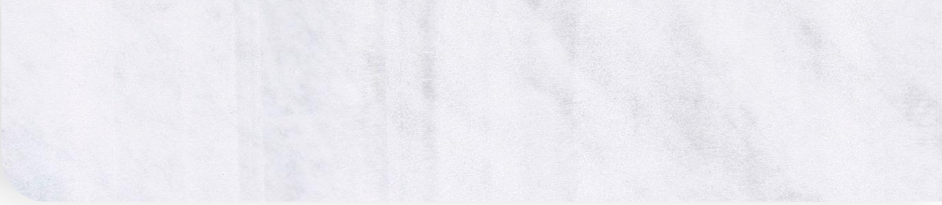
- Respect should be **balanced with moral judgment**.
- If authority misuses power (e.g., unethical or illegal orders), professionals have a duty to **question respectfully** or use proper channels to report misconduct.
- Ethical respect = **obedience + accountability + moral courage**.



Benefits of Respecting Authority

- Creates harmony in professional and social life.
- Reduces conflicts and misunderstandings.
- Encourages ethical decision-making within organizations.
- Strengthens **leadership and teamwork**.
- Helps individuals develop **discipline and responsibility**.





Collective bargaining

- **Collective Bargaining** is the process of **negotiation between employers and employees (through unions or representatives)** to reach agreements on working conditions, salaries, benefits, and other aspects of employment.
- It is called "collective" because workers act as a group rather than as individuals, which gives them greater negotiating power.
- It is both a **right** and an **ethical practice** to ensure fairness in workplace relationships.



Objectives of Collective Bargaining

- To protect **workers' rights** and improve working conditions.
- To ensure **fair wages, reasonable hours, and safe environments**.
- To reduce **industrial disputes** and promote cooperation.
- To create a **balance of power** between management and employees.
- To establish a culture of **dialogue and mutual respect**.



Features of Collective Bargaining

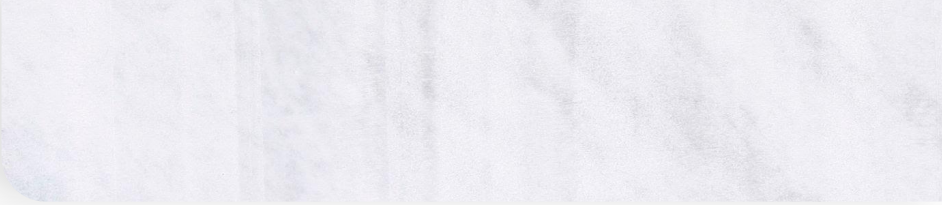
- It is a **two-way process** (employers and employees both participate).
- It involves **negotiation, compromise, and agreement**.
- Agreements are usually **formal and binding** (e.g., contracts).
- It is a **continuous process**—agreements need revision with time.



Types of Collective Bargaining

1. **Distributive Bargaining** – Negotiation where one party's gain is the other's loss (e.g., wage increase vs. cost to employer).
2. **Integrative Bargaining** – Win-win approach where both sides benefit (e.g., better training for employees increases productivity).
3. **Productivity Bargaining** – Linking wages and benefits with productivity improvements.
4. **Concession Bargaining** – Workers agree to give up certain benefits during tough economic times to save jobs.

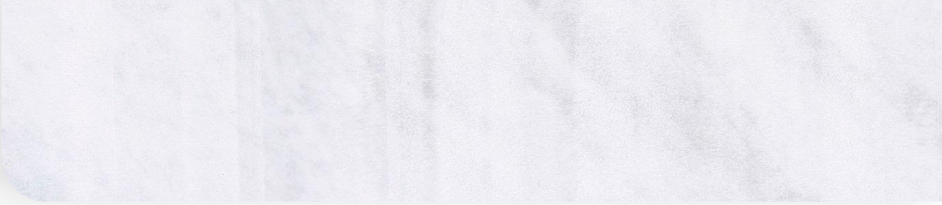




Examples of Collective Bargaining

- **Engineering Industry:** Workers demand improved safety equipment in factories; management agrees after negotiation.
- **IT Industry:** Employees, through associations, negotiate for flexible working hours and health benefits.
- **Public Sector:** Trade unions bargain with government for salary hikes and pension benefits.

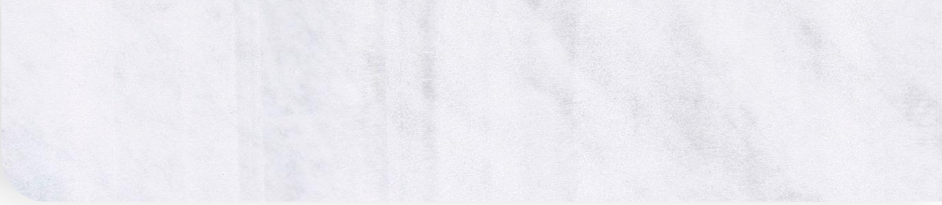




Ethical Importance

- Promotes **justice and fairness** in the workplace.
- Reduces exploitation by ensuring **employees have a voice**.
- Encourages **cooperation instead of conflict**.
- Helps build **trust and long-term relationships** between management and workers.





Limitations / Challenges

- Sometimes unions and employers may become rigid, causing strikes/lockouts.
- May focus too much on wages and ignore broader professional ethics.
- If misused, it can harm organizational efficiency.



Conflicts of interest

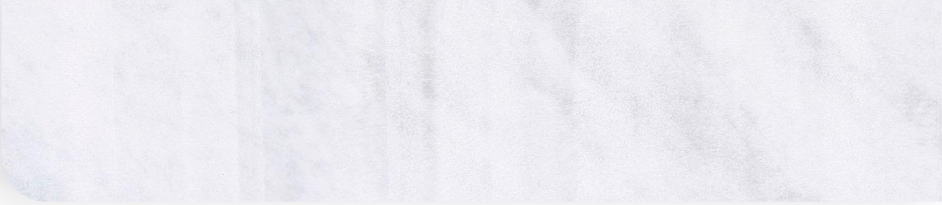
- A **Conflict of Interest (COI)** occurs when a person's **personal interests** (financial, family, relationships, or personal gain) **interfere with their professional duties, responsibilities, or decisions**.
- It creates a situation where professional judgment may be **biased, compromised, or appear unethical**, even if no harm is intended.
- A **software engineer** is assigned to evaluate bids for a government IT contract. One of the bidding companies is owned by their sibling.
 - Ethical Action: The engineer should **disclose the relationship** and withdraw from the evaluation committee.



Types of Conflicts of Interest

1. **Actual Conflict** – A real, direct clash between personal and professional interest.
 - *Example:* An engineer approving safety equipment supplied by a company owned by their relative.
2. **Perceived (Apparent) Conflict** – A situation that may look like a conflict to outsiders, even if no unethical act occurs.
 - *Example:* A professor grading the exam of their close friend's child.
3. **Potential Conflict** – A situation where personal interest might influence future decisions.
 - *Example:* An employee negotiating a contract with a company that has offered them a job.

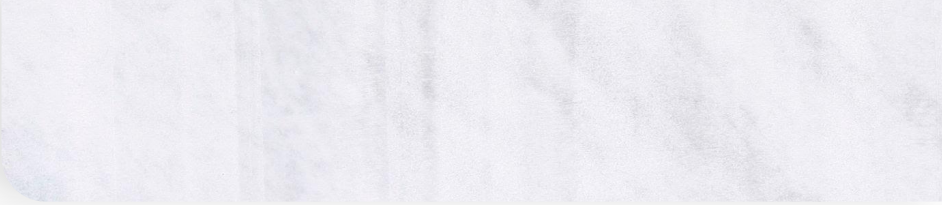




Examples in Professional Life

- **Engineering:** A consultant hired to evaluate a project also owns shares in the contractor's firm.
- **Business:** A purchasing manager awards contracts to suppliers who offer personal gifts.
- **Academics:** A researcher favors results that benefit the funding organization instead of reporting truth.
- **Government:** A public official using their influence to benefit family businesses.

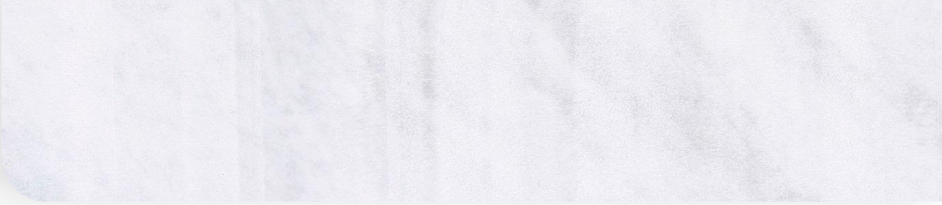




Ethical Concerns

- Conflicts of interest damage **trust, fairness, and integrity**.
- They may lead to **biased decision-making**, corruption, or exploitation.
- Even the **appearance of conflict** can harm an individual's or organization's reputation.

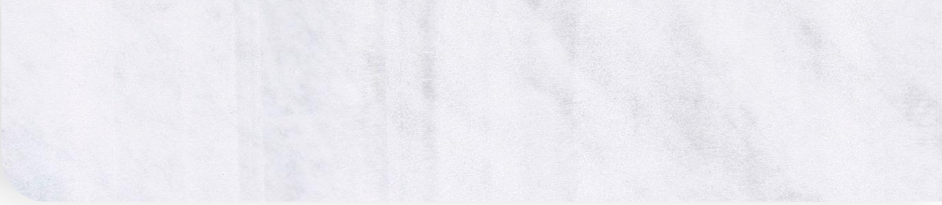




How to Manage Conflicts of Interest

1. **Disclosure** – Openly declare personal interests that might interfere.
2. **Recusal** – Step aside from decision-making in situations of conflict.
3. **Transparency** – Keep processes open and well-documented.
4. **Policies & Codes of Conduct** – Organizations should establish clear guidelines.
5. **Ethical Awareness** – Professionals should constantly evaluate their choices.

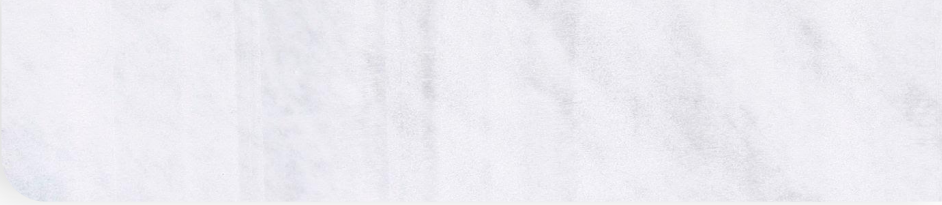




Occupational crime

- It refers to **illegal or unethical acts committed by individuals during the course of their occupation** for personal or organizational gain.
- These crimes are often **non-violent**, but they involve misuse of **professional authority, trust, or position**.
- It is sometimes called **white-collar crime**.





Characteristics

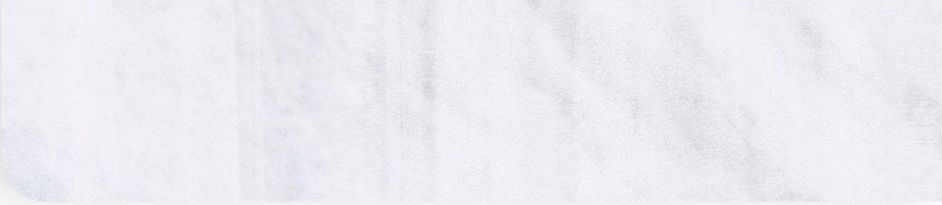
- Committed by people in **professional or official roles**.
- Involves **abuse of trust or authority**.
- Usually carried out in **workplaces, organizations, or public offices**.
- Motivated by **financial gain, personal benefit, or organizational advantage**.
- Harder to detect compared to street crimes because offenders are often educated and influential.



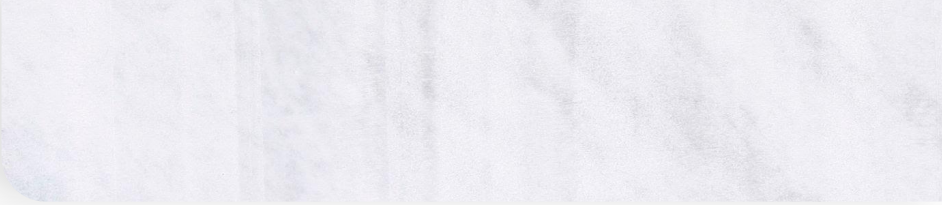
Types of Occupational Crime

1. **Embezzlement** – Misappropriation of funds entrusted to one's care.
 - *Ex:* An accountant diverts company money into their personal account.
2. **Fraud** – Deception to gain unlawful advantage.
 - *Ex:* A researcher fakes experimental results to secure more funding.
3. **Bribery and Corruption** – Accepting or offering illegal payments to influence decisions.
 - *Ex:* An engineer approves low-quality construction material in exchange for money.



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4. **Insider Trading** – Using confidential company information for personal stock market profit.
 5. **Misuse of Resources** – Using company property for personal purposes.
 - *Example:* A manager using office vehicles for private family trips.
 6. **Conflict of Interest-based Crimes** – Making biased decisions for personal benefit rather than professional duty.





Examples

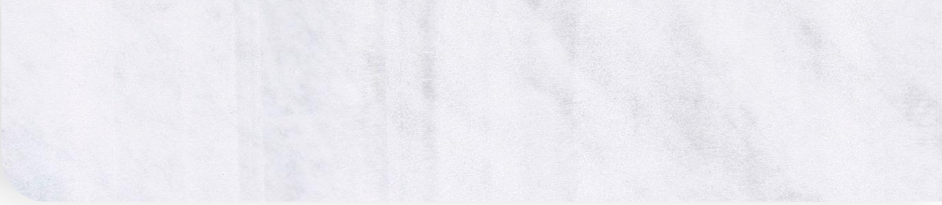
- **Business:** A manager takes a commission from suppliers for giving contracts.
- **Engineering:** A safety inspector ignores violations after being offered gifts.
- **Government:** A public official awarding tenders to relatives' companies.
- **Academics:** A professor using research funds for personal travel.



Ethical Issues

- Violates **trust and responsibility**.
- Harms **organizations, employees, and the public**.
- Creates unfair advantages and exploitation.
- Damages the **reputation of the profession**.





Preventive Measures

1. **Codes of Conduct** – Clear professional ethical guidelines.
2. **Transparency** – Open reporting and auditing systems.
3. **Whistleblowing** – Encourage reporting of unethical practices.
4. **Strict Laws & Penalties** – To deter offenders.
5. **Ethics Training** – Create awareness among professionals.



Case Example

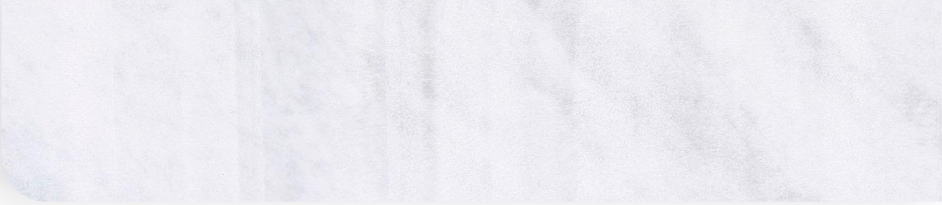
- A **bridge construction project** collapses because engineers approved substandard materials after taking bribes.
 - This is an **occupational crime** (corruption + negligence) and highlights the ethical duty of engineers to prioritize **public safety over personal gain**.





Occupational Crime vs. Corporate Crime

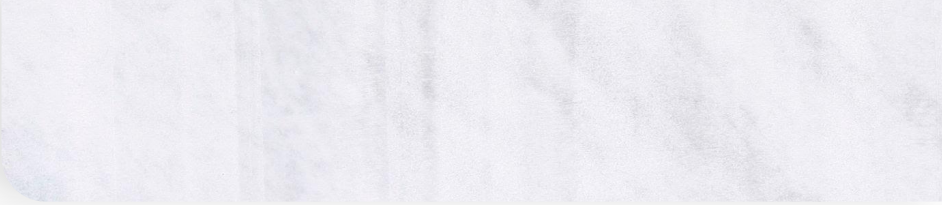
Aspect	Occupational Crime	Corporate Crime
Definition	Illegal/unethical acts committed by an individual employee or professional during the course of their job for personal gain .	Illegal/unethical acts committed by a company or organization (as a whole) , or by senior executives, to benefit the corporation .
Focus	Personal benefit of the individual.	Benefit of the organization/corporation.
Perpetrator	Usually an individual employee, manager, or professional misusing their position.	Top management, board of directors, or the organization itself.
Examples	- Embezzlement by an accountant	



Quick Example:

- **Occupational Crime:** An engineer in a company secretly diverts project funds into their personal account (embezzlement).
 - **Corporate Crime:** A chemical company deliberately dumps toxic waste into a river to reduce costs, harming the environment.
 - **Occupational Crime** = committed by **individuals** within their jobs for **personal gain**.
 - **Corporate Crime** = committed by the **organization** or its leadership for **corporate gain**.
- Both are unethical and damage **trust, safety, and professional integrity**





Role in technological development

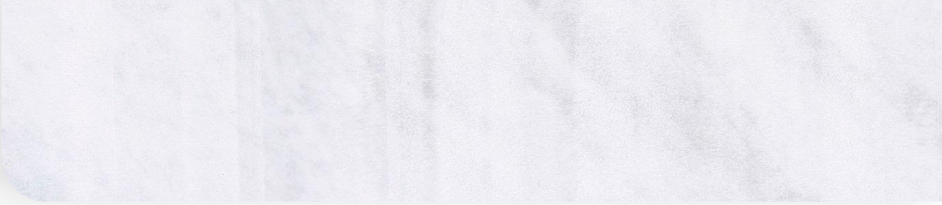
- **Technology** is the application of knowledge, tools, and processes to solve problems and improve human life.
- Professionals, especially **engineers, scientists, and technologists**, play a critical role in driving technological development while ensuring **ethical responsibility**.

Roles of Professionals in Technological Development

1. Innovation and Creativity

- Professionals design and invent new technologies to improve efficiency, comfort, and safety.
- *Example:* Engineers developing electric vehicles to reduce pollution.





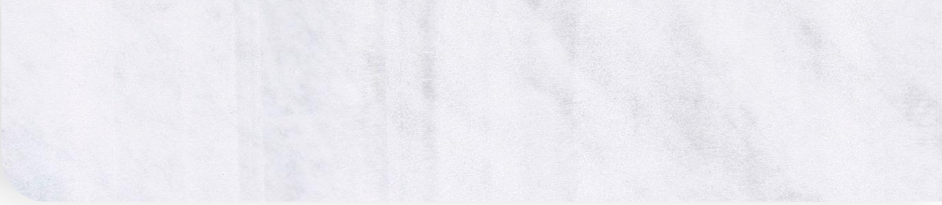
2. Problem Solving

- Technology is created to solve **real-world problems** in healthcare, transportation, communication, and environment.
- *Example:* Development of water purification systems in rural areas.

3. Sustainability

- Modern development must balance **progress with environmental responsibility**.
- *Ex:* Use of renewable energy (solar, wind) instead of fossil fuels.





4. Ethical Responsibility

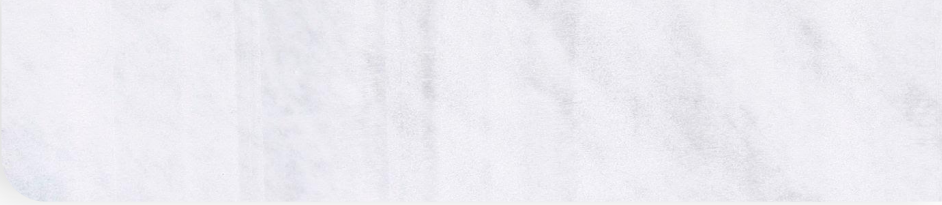
- Engineers must ensure technology is **safe, fair, and does not harm society**.
- *Ex:* Avoiding unsafe construction methods to cut costs.

5. Social Transformation

- Technology changes how people live, work, and interact.
- *Ex:* The Internet revolutionized education, business, and communication.

6. Global Competitiveness

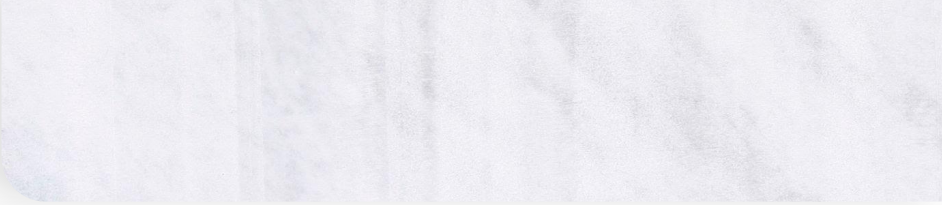
- Nations with strong technological development achieve **economic growth and global leadership**.
 - *Ex:* Countries investing in AI and robotics dominate global markets.
- 



Ethical Issues in Technological Development

- **Privacy concerns** (e.g., misuse of personal data in AI systems).
- **Digital divide** – unequal access to technology between rich and poor.
- **Job displacement** due to automation.
- **Environmental impact** of industrial technologies.
- **Security risks** – cybercrime and hacking.





Case Examples

1. **Engineering:** Development of high-rise buildings with earthquake-resistant technology to save lives.
2. **Healthcare:** AI-assisted diagnosis improving accuracy in medical treatment.
3. **Environment:** Electric vehicles reducing dependency on fossil fuels.



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